The Table with the Little Ending

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 5, Episode 6

The heavy guide tipped one corner of the work table. Nib held up a tall bottle as a possible support. Lark pointed to the table's own loose foot fitting. Adding a fragile tower would leave the actual fault untouched.

“A bottle would add height,” Nib argued hopefully. “The foot would add steadiness,” Lark replied gently.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **farmer**

“At the end of table, consonant-le makes an unstressed chunk,” Lark modeled clearly. “Listen to table, candle, and bottle. Join the chunks into their ordinary spoken words rather than reciting separate letter names or making every vowel equally strong.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try table, candle, bottle. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read table on the support note,” Lark invited gently. “Which fitting belongs to its own foot?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The bottle is on the table. A candle is by it.**

“Where is the bottle?” Lark asked gently. “Which object does it refer to in the other sentence?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

The keeper supported the table while Nib tightened the foot. The guide opened without rocking. The bottle stayed on a shelf, where it did not have to hold a work station upright. Now the crew could compare the water-bed drawing and its actual low measuring notch.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write table beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal showed a table supported by its own foot. Beyond the shelter, a tall marker stood beside the low water-line notch, giving the next reading two very different heights to consider.